

Find My Ride

Reducing uncertainty when riders and drivers cannot convert an app pin into a workable meeting point

62

unique survey submissions

24 / 51

recent users reporting difficulty

4

driver responses — evidence gap

3

research-led ideas to test

What we actually researched

A deliberate method choice under constraint — stated up front, not buried in a footnote.

METHOD CHOICE

Synchronous interviews were not feasible in the available window. I built a multilingual self-serve research app instead: rider/driver branches, structured tags, and four optional open-text or voice prompts.

DEPTH ACHIEVED

62 unique respondents. 30 answered at least one open-ended narrative prompt, 11 gave extended accounts, and 3 completed all four detailed prompts.

TRADEOFF

No live probing and no follow-up on surprising answers. Depth per respondent is lower than a moderated interview; breadth, language coverage and traceability are higher.

62 unique submissions • 58 riders • 4 drivers • 33 Hyderabad / 29 other cities • 30 open-ended responses

The screenshot shows a mobile app interface titled "Pickup Story". At the top, there are three language selection buttons: "EN" (highlighted in orange), "TE", and "HI". Below the title, it says "6 / 17". The main prompt is: "Tell us about the most recent time this happened — from booking until you met your driver, or the ride was cancelled." This is followed by a horizontal line and the word "Optional". Below this is a large text input area with the placeholder text "Type here, or tap the mic to speak...". To the right of the input area is a small microphone icon. Below the input area, there is a note: "Tap the mic to speak your answer instead of typing." At the bottom of the screen, there are two buttons: "Back" and "Next" (highlighted in orange).

Live app
English • Telugu • Hindi

<https://praveenveera.github.io/uber-pickup-survey/>

Full consent, question-flow, and anonymized-response evidence is included in the evidence ZIP.

The coordination job starts where the map stops

Discovery shows what happens. Framing defines the user, context, desired outcome, and boundaries.

WORKING JTBD • ASSUMPTION TO VALIDATE

When I am waiting at a complex pickup location, help my driver and me agree on a legal, easy-to-recognize meeting point so the trip can start without repeated calls, extra movement, or cancellation.

EVIDENCE-BASED FRAME

At complex pickup locations, the app pin can identify an area without giving rider and driver a shared, workable meeting point.

TARGET SEGMENT

Primary: Hyderabad four-wheel riders starting at airports, gated residences, malls, offices, and transit hubs.
Secondary: drivers serving those pickups.

ASSUMPTIONS AND GUARDRAILS

A structured handoff may reduce recovery effort. Do not assume the map is always wrong, every cancellation is location-related, or every ride needs this help.

Why framing is difficult: failures mix location, venue rules, user behavior, fare or destination issues, and thin driver evidence.

Guidance exists — focus on coverage, clarity, and recovery

Competitor evidence establishes design precedents, not validated Hyderabad outcomes.

UBER HYDERABAD BASELINE

Uber's HYD guidance points riders to in-app directions and a D1 pickup zone. The case is not “Uber has no pickup guidance.”

GLOBAL PATTERNS

Grab uses venue visuals and meeting points. Lyft uses pickup notes. Waymo makes accessible stops and walking trade-offs explicit.

INDIAN ACCESS PATTERN

MyGate shows how a privacy-aware gate handoff can work. Historical Ola evidence shows physical zones or human help, but not a current capability.

Product implication

Test a reusable coordination layer for complex places: valid stopping context, concise handoff information, and one visible recovery step when coordination stalls.

Restrictions to design around: no-stopping and access rules, venue operations, accessibility, privacy, and data minimization. Exact local rules require venue-level validation.

A sizing model with a named missing denominator

Refusing a fabricated TAM is the finding — not an omission.

SIZING MODEL

Annual affected pickups = Hyderabad Uber four-wheel pickups × share beginning at complex locations × share hitting material difficulty. None of the three inputs exists in a reliable public source, so no TAM is claimed.

EXPOSURE POOLS — NOT THE PROBLEM

Hyderabad Airport: 30M+ passengers FY2025-26. Hyderabad Metro: 4.75 lakh+ average daily riders across 57 stations. Secunderabad station: ~1.30 lakh per normal day, 2 lakh+ during festivals.

WHERE DEMAND CONCENTRATES

Segment by location type, not demographics. Among 28 issue cases: airport 10, gated residential 7, mall 6, office 6, metro/rail 5, street 3, hotel 2, hospital 1.

Market trends

Regulatory tailwind — MV Aggregator Guidelines 2025 mandate in-journey location sharing, accessibility features and language support.
Category maturing — Uber already ships HYD airport guidance; Lyft ships pickup notes; Grab ships venue meeting points.
Curb space tightening — access-control windows now appear at Indian transport hubs, such as Secunderabad's 15-minute pickup/drop rule.
Privacy bar rising — the DPDP Act 2023 constrains how venue and location data can be collected and retained.

Telangana's adoption of the 2025 central guidelines and venue-level stopping rules both require legal and on-site verification. This is product research, not legal advice.

One question and one honest measurement gap

When a pickup becomes difficult, what breaks — and what do riders and drivers actually do to recover?

CANDIDATE OUTCOME

Pickups completed without avoidable calls, location changes, extended waiting, or cancellation.

MEASUREMENT GAP

If reliable event logs exist, compare driver-arrived to trip-start dwell, calls/messages, location changes, and cancellations at complex locations.

This is a proposed measurement direction — not a confirmed Uber metric or a one-day data pull.

Not everyone's problem — but a real, recurring one for affected respondents

47.1%

24 of 51 recent users reported difficulty or uncertainty

82.1%

23 of 28 issue cases said it happened before

20 / 28

said calling or messaging helped

6 / 28

said nothing helped

“The app says he has arrived, but almost 10 minutes to locate each other.”

R067 · rider · anonymized response

Interpretation boundary: 23 of 28 means the issue occurred before; it does not prove recurrence at the same venue. These sample percentages are not Hyderabad prevalence. The 28 issue cases are the 24 recent four-wheel users plus 3 respondents with no recent four-wheel trip and 1 unsure, all of whom reported a pickup issue.

Where coordination breaks — and how people recover

Problem locations among 28 issue cases — top 6 of 8 types



Recovery actions



The app often hands the last physical coordination step back to the rider and driver. Calls work often — but they add effort and do not provide a reliable fallback when coordination still fails.

Make the fallback faster — not the map more complicated

Recommended direction

Reduce the effort and uncertainty of manual pickup recovery at a defined set of complex location types.

TEST ORDER

- P0 · Structured pre-arrival meeting note
- P1 · Guided stalled-pickup recovery
- P2 · Venue-specific coordination information

DO NOT

Do not add friction to every ride, position this as an airport-only problem, or treat all cancellations as map failures.

Biggest open risk: driver evidence and marketplace economics are too thin to support a two-sided rollout decision.

Structured pre-arrival meeting note

Strongest first test because it formalizes an existing user-created workaround.

TRIGGER

Only at flagged complex pickup locations, a few minutes before driver arrival.

ACTION

Prompt one concise handoff: gate or side, landmark, and waiting spot — reusable where appropriate.

WHY THIS FIRST

Calls/messages helped in 20 of 28 issue cases. R061 already sends these details manually — and reported no pickup difficulty.

TEST

At comparable flagged locations, compare reactive call/message rate, arrived-to-trip-start dwell, location changes, and cancellations.

“I always place a message on where I would stand with details.” — R061

Recovery when coordination stalls — then reusable venue context

P1 • GUIDED STALLED-PICKUP RECOVERY

Trigger after an arrived state remains unresolved past a defined threshold. First guide reconnect actions: share live location, confirm a meeting cue, and retry contact. Test reassignment only for unresolved cases, because it carries marketplace and compensation risk.

P2 • VENUE-SPECIFIC COORDINATION INFORMATION

Pilot at 2–3 validated venues. Show accessible gate or side, legal stopping point, expected walk, and access constraints. Treat repeat-issue evidence as a problem signal — not proof that the same venue failed repeatedly.

Guardrails: trigger only on genuine coordination stalls; assign venue-data ownership and expiry; validate driver impact before scaling.

A defensible direction — not a “build it” recommendation

Test the smallest coordination aid first: a structured note at flagged complex pickups. Move to recovery and venue data only if the evidence supports it.

LIMITS

Convenience sample; interview requirement unmet; 4 drivers; optional open-text depth; 29 other-city responses; no reliable local market denominator.

NEXT RESEARCH

Run 6 moderated rider and 4 driver interviews if feasible; include accessibility and venue-operations perspectives.

NEXT DATA

If event logs are trustworthy, baseline arrived-to-trip-start dwell, contacts, location changes, and cancellations at selected venues.

Appendix: full method, top 10 insights, competitor patterns, idea tests, limitations, and source traceability.

APPENDIX

The evidence behind every claim

Methodology · Top 10 insights · Market and competitor patterns · Strategy reconciliation · Product tests · Limitations · Sources

Online survey evidence and the exact requirement gap

- 62 unique submissions after removing confirmed duplicate R032
- 58 riders and 4 drivers; driver conclusions remain open
- 33 Hyderabad and 29 other-city responses
- Self-serve, asynchronous, consent-gated interface in English, Telugu, and Hindi
- Four optional open-text or voice prompts plus structured tags
- Contact details and raw payload excluded from the sanitized workbook
- Asynchronous online research, not synchronous in-depth interviews: 30 respondents answered open-ended prompts, but no answer could be probed live

The image displays two screenshots of a mobile application interface titled "Pickup Story".

Left Screenshot (Screen 11 / 17):

- Header: "Pickup Story" with language selection buttons (EN, TE, HI).
- Progress indicator: "11 / 17".
- Title: "Where were you? (choose all that apply)".
- Options (each with a checkbox):
 - Airport
 - Shopping mall
 - Office or tech campus
 - Metro or railway station
 - Hospital
 - Hotel or event venue
 - Busy street
 - Residential complex / gated
 - Other
- Navigation buttons: "Back" and "Next".

Right Screenshot (Screen 14 / 17):

- Header: "Pickup Story" with language selection buttons (EN, TE, HI).
- Progress indicator: "14 / 17".
- Title: "What finally helped, if anything? (choose all that apply)".
- Options (each with a checkbox):
 - Calling or messaging each other
 - Walking to a shared landmark
 - Driver moved closer to me
 - Security or staff helped
 - Nothing helped — had to cancel
 - Something else
- Navigation buttons: "Back" and "Next".

Live app and full-size screenshots are included in the evidence ZIP.

The ten questions the instrument asked

Template section 1.1 — asked asynchronously, without live follow-up.

- Tell me about the last time you had difficulty finding your ride after booking it.
- Where were you, and what did the app tell you?
- When did you first realize the pickup might not work as expected?
- What made the rider and driver difficult to locate or identify?
- What did you do next: call, message, move, wait, cancel, or seek help?
- How much extra time or effort did the situation require?
- What finally helped, if anything?
- Has the same problem happened at other locations?
- What information or support was missing at the most frustrating moment?
- For drivers: what prevented you from reaching the pin or identifying the rider?

The four narrative prompts were optional in the interface, and the form could not ask a follow-up when an answer was vague.

Insights 1–5: prevalence, recurrence, location, arrived state, and recovery

1

Difficulty is meaningful, not universal

24/51 reported difficulty or uncertainty; 34/62 no issue

Strong

2

For affected respondents, the issue often recurs

23/28 said it happened before — not necessarily same venue

Strong

3

Complex environments concentrate coordination failures

Airport 10; residential 7; mall 6; office 6

Strong

4

Arrived does not mean the rider and driver can meet

Wrong pin, similar gates, cross-road case

Moderate

5

Calling and messaging are the main recovery layer

20/28 said calling or messaging helped

Strong

Insights 6–10: recovery burden, delay, cancellation, support, and identification

6

The rider often absorbs the recovery effort

Waited 9; moved 8; driver moved helped 3

Moderate

7

Pickup failures can create material delay

7/10 time-tagged cases exceeded five minutes

Moderate

8

Cancellation is related but multi-causal

Location overlaps with destination, fare, payment, and rain

Moderate

9

Some respondents found no effective recovery

6/28 selected nothing helped

Moderate

10

Finding the ride includes vehicle identification

One vehicle-number mismatch report

Weak

Design patterns — with transferability limits

Reference	Observed mechanism	Lesson for this case	Boundary
Uber HYD	In-app directions and D1 pickup zone	Baseline exists; test coverage and failed coordination	Airport-only evidence
Grab	Venue visuals and curated meeting points	Make landmarks and paths concrete	Global / experimental claims
Lyft	Pickup Notes and selective assisted rides	Structured context and recovery precedent	US market
Waymo	Navigable stops; walking preference	Explain vehicle-access vs walking trade-off	US autonomous rides
MyGate	Privacy-aware gate handoff	Access-aware residential coordination	Adjacent Indian product

What the evidence changes — and what it does not support

PARTIALLY SUPPORTED

Indoor-to-outdoor navigation matters, but gated residences, offices, and streets show a broader shared-reference-point problem.

SUPPORTED, THIN

Access and stopping constraints matter; driver evidence is only four responses, so desk research carries more weight here.

SUPPORTED

“Pickup failure” combines location confusion, recovery effort, destination preference, fare, payment, and driver behavior.

NOT SUPPORTED

A universal prompt, airport-only strategy, precise Hyderabad prevalence, or a driver-specific solution cannot be justified from this evidence.

DECISION

Use location type and stall signals to target coordination help. Validate rider benefit and driver impact before building a broader venue data operation.

Three ideas, sequenced by evidence strength and operating risk

#	Idea	Trigger / scope	Primary measures	Main risk
P0	Pre-arrival meeting note	Flagged complex location; before arrival	Calls/messages, dwell, location changes	Added friction if over-triggered
P1	Guided stalled-pickup recovery	Arrived state unresolved past threshold	Resolution and unresolved-cancellation rate	False triggers; driver compensation
P2	Venue-specific coordination info	2–3 validated venues	Calls/messages and dwell vs matched venues	Stale rules; ownership cost

Sequence is a test order, not a committed build roadmap.

What kind of evidence this is

- Convenience sample recruited through available networks; not representative of Hyderabad riders
- Online survey with interview-style prompts; 30 open-ended responses but no live probing, so qualitative depth is shallower than a moderated interview
- Four driver responses; two-sided product and marketplace conclusions remain premature
- Open prompts were optional and the schema changed during collection, so qualitative depth varies
- Twenty-nine of 62 responses came from other cities; they are comparison evidence, not a small side sample
- Consent was required in the interface but not stored as a separate backend field
- Multi-select location and action counts are mentions, not mutually exclusive people
- No reliable Hyderabad trip-volume or issue-rate denominator was found; no market-size figure is claimed

Every claim traces to a source or an explicit limitation

PRIMARY EVIDENCE

Sanitized-Survey-Evidence.xlsx
Survey-Dashboard.png
Screenshots/
Live-URL.txt

DESK AND COMPETITOR EVIDENCE

Competitor-Analysis.md
Desk-Research-Report.md
Source-Register.md
Raw internet workbook retained privately

SYNTHESIS

01-survey-insights.md
02-strategy-implications.md
04-product-ideas.md

HARD SUBMISSION GATE

Video link is pending. Before submission: record presenter-visible video under 5 minutes, upload it, add the working link, and verify access.

Evidence ZIP excludes participant contacts, raw API payloads, test rows, internal artifacts, and the raw internet workbook containing public creator contacts.